

middle and asked to decide which parent to side with. In the meantime, the grandparents also began to pull the kids by buying them expensive presents while they were visiting.

As the children grew up, they became more and more difficult to control. Both Al and Carol realized they were wrong, but were trapped by past bitternesses and pride.

At last, a Christian friend of Al's invited them to a weekend family conference where the topics were communications and finances. The weekend had a profound effect on both Al and Carol, and they rededicated their lives to the Lord.

In applying some of the principles they had learned, they decided to stop requiring that their two teenage sons give to the church, and they began regularly attending church as a family.

Their sons immediately stopped all giving and told their parents they would rather not even go to church anymore. The parents were stunned to discover the true spiritual condition of their children. It was all head knowledge and no heart knowledge. The parental examples spoke much louder than any pastor or Sunday School teacher.

Al and Carol had a long way to go to win back the hearts of their children before they became adults. Fortunately they woke up in time to have some influence while the children were still under their daily authority. Within five years they saw all of their children accept Jesus and commit to His service. The kids no longer required Mom or Dad to tell them to give. In fact, they challenged their parents to give more and spend less.

WHERE DO YOU START?

Where should you start in teaching your children? First, I would like to offer three fundamental principles that are applicable to everyone, parents *and* children. These are condensed from our Youth Bible Study series called, "God's Guide through the Money Jungle."

(1) *Teach your children that God owns everything by allowing them to see this principle in your lives.* Demonstrate that you're